FREE GUIDE · US

The $50-a-Week Grocery Plan

A simple 7-day meal plan and shopping list for 1–2 people.

One shopping trip. Same basic foods, cooked in different ways.

Prices in this guide are rough estimates. Your total will depend on your store, city and the week. This is general information, not a promise of savings and not medical advice.

How it works

1. **Shop one time.** Rough target: $50, one big trip, on Saturday or Sunday.
2. **Cook the same base foods** in different ways: rice, beans, eggs, chicken, pasta.
3. **Batch cook on Sunday.** The 7-day plan starts Monday. Eat leftovers for lunch.
4. **Check your store app** for free coupons and sales before you go.

Honest note about prices: the $45–$55 total is a rough estimate for 1–2 people. Prices change by store, city and season. You may spend less or more. Swap items for whatever is on sale.

Who this is for

Students, singles and couples who want a simple plan that cuts down on guessing at the store. Bigger family? Double rice, beans and pasta first.

Shopping list

Rough estimate: $45–$55 for 1–2 people.

Protein

- 1 dozen eggs
- 2 lb chicken thighs or drumsticks (family pack)
- 1 lb dry black beans (or 2 cans)
- 1 can tuna *or* 1 lb ground turkey/beef (pick one)

Carbs

- 2 lb long-grain rice
- 1 loaf bread
- 1 box pasta (16 oz)
- 5 lb potatoes
- 1 canister oats (18 oz)

Vegetables and fruit

- 1 bag frozen mixed vegetables
- 1 bag carrots + 3 onions
- 1 head cabbage *or* 1 bag spinach
- 1 can crushed tomatoes + 1 jar pasta sauce
- 4–5 bananas or apples (cheapest that week)

Shopping list (continued)

Basics (skip if you already have them)

- Cooking oil, salt, pepper
- Garlic powder, chili powder, cumin
- Peanut butter

Quick tips at the store

- Eat first and bring a written list.
- Check the **unit price** (price per ounce) on the shelf tag.
- Store brands are often cheaper. Compare the unit price.
- Frozen vegetables keep for months and cut waste.

Allergy, health condition or special diet? Change the foods to what is safe for you.

The 7-day plan

Monday	
Breakfast	Eggs + toast
Lunch	Rice + beans
Dinner	Chicken thighs, rice, frozen veg

Tuesday	
Breakfast	Oats or toast + banana
Lunch	Leftover chicken rice bowl
Dinner	Pasta + tomato sauce + veg

Wednesday	
Breakfast	Eggs + toast
Lunch	Rice + beans
Dinner	Potato and egg skillet

Thursday	
Breakfast	Oats or toast + peanut butter
Lunch	Pasta leftovers
Dinner	Chicken soup (leftover chicken, carrots, onion, rice)

The 7-day plan (continued)

Friday	
Breakfast	Eggs + toast
Lunch	Soup leftovers
Dinner	Bean and rice bowl (or tuna pasta)

Saturday	
Breakfast	Oats + peanut butter
Lunch	Peanut butter sandwich + fruit
Dinner	Fried rice with eggs + frozen veg

Sunday	
Breakfast	Egg scramble + veg
Lunch	Rice + beans
Dinner	"Clean-out-the-fridge" bowl

Swaps: no chicken? Use extra eggs and beans. Vegetarian? Replace chicken with beans and eggs. Bored? Change the spices: cumin, chili powder or garlic powder.

Sunday batch cook (about 60 min)

- Cook **4 cups dry rice** (about 12 cups cooked).
- Simmer **1 lb beans** with an onion, garlic powder, cumin and salt.
- Bake **all the chicken** at 425°F (220°C) for 35–40 minutes. Check that the inside reaches **165°F (74°C)**.
- Freeze half of the chicken right away. Thaw it in the fridge on Wednesday night.
- Chop carrots and onions for the week. Store them in a container.

Food safety

- Put cooked food in the fridge within **2 hours**.
- Eat fridge leftovers within **3–4 days**.
- Reheat to **165°F (74°C)**.
- When in doubt, throw it out.

5 habits to try

1. **Check the unit price** on the shelf tag, not the big price.
2. **Try store brand** for basics like rice, pasta and canned goods.
3. **Use frozen vegetables.** They keep longer, so less goes to waste.
4. **Never shop hungry.** Bring a written list.
5. **Waste less.** Old bread becomes toast or croutons. Extra rice becomes fried rice.

Please remember: this is a general guide. Prices, results and nutrition needs are different for every person. It does not promise any amount of savings and it is not medical or dietary advice.

Share it

If this helped, send it to a friend who is watching their budget.